Seeing Through Photographs ✕

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Introduction to Seeing Through Photographs

Module 2
One Subject, Many Perspectives

Module 3
Documents and the Documentary

Module 4
One and Another

Part I: Introduction

✓ Introduction to Module 4
Reading • 2 min

✓ Sarah Meister on Photography and Multiplicity
Video • 2 min

Part II: Albums and Books

✓ Artwork Spotlight: Frances Benjamin Johnston's The Hampton Album, 1899-1900
Reading • 2 min

✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Frances Benjamin Johnston. The Hampton Album. 1899-1900
Video • 1 min

✓ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min

✓ Photo Books
Reading • 8 min

Part III: Bodies of Work

✓ Photo Series
Reading • 13 min

✓ Hear More: Nicholas Nixon on The Brown Sisters, 1975–2022
Video • 1 min

✓ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min

✓ Hear More: Sohrab Hura on Snow, 2015–ongoing
Video • 5 min

Part IV: One from Many

✓ One from Many
Reading • 8 min

✓ Hear More: Irina Rozovsky on Miracle Center, 2019–ongoing
Video • 5 min

Part V: Review and Respond

✓ Practice Memory Check
Practice Assignment • Grade: 80%

✓ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
Reading • 10 min

✓ Optional Readings and Resources
Reading • 10 min

✓ Optional Mid-Course Survey
Reading • 5 min

Module 5
Constructing Narratives, Challenging Histories

Part I: Introduction

✓ Introduction to Module 5
Reading • 2 min

○ **Artwork Spotlight: Hank Willis Thomas's UNBRANDED series**
Reading • 2 min

○ Hank Willis Thomas on the Role of Advertising Images
Video • 3 min

Part II: Re-envisioning History

○ Constructing History
Reading • 4 min

○ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min

○ Challenging History
Reading • 6 min

○ Hear More: Carrie Mae Weems on From Here I Saw What Happened and I Cried, 1995–96
Video • 2 min

○ Hear More: Walid Raad of The Atlas Group on My neck is thinner than a hair: Engines, 1996–2001
Video • 1 min

○ Practical Scenario
Real-world application • 5 min

○ Hear More: Harrell Fletcher on The American War, 2005
Video • 4 min

Part III: Envisioning Selves and Stereotypes

○ Constructing Personal Narratives
Reading • 10 min

○ Hear More: Iñaki Bonillas on Constructing Identities
Video • 6 min

○ Hear More: Eva Respini on Cindy Sherman. Untitled Film Stills. 1977–80
Video • 1 min

○ Hear More: David Alekhuogie on To Live and Die in LA, 2019
Video • 4 min

Part IV: Review and Respond

○ Practice Memory Check
Practice Assignment • 30 min

○ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
Reading • 10 min

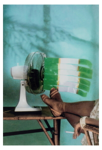
○ Optional Readings and Resources
Reading • 10 min

Module 6
Pictures of People

Module 7
Ocean of Images

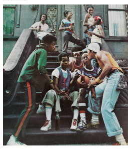
Artwork Spotlight: Hank Willis Thomas's UNBRANDED series

0:06 / 1:24 1x



Hank Willis Thomas. *The Refreshest, 1987*. 2007. Chromogenic color print, 29 15/16 x 20 5/8" (76.1 x 52.4 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Fund for the Twenty-First Century. © 2020 Hank Willis Thomas

To make his UNBRANDED series, Hank Willis Thomas appropriated advertisements aimed at Black consumers and removed their text and marketing logos, representing them as the images alone. Beginning with 1968, a key year in the American Civil Rights movement, Thomas mined four decades of commercial images featured in magazines like *Jet* and *Ebony*. He chose two from each year and titled the works after the advertising campaigns from which they are sourced. By separating the images from their original contexts, Thomas calls attention to the ways in which media and advertising adopt, reinforce, and inform stereotypes about race in our society. About his work, Thomas states, "I am interested in the ways that popular imagery informs how people perceive themselves and others around the world."



Hank Willis Thomas. *It's the Real Thing!, 1978*. 2006. Chromogenic color print, 27 x 24 1/8" (68.6 x 61.3 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Fund for the Twenty-First Century. © 2020 Hank Willis Thomas

Mark as completed

Like Dislike Report an issue

Go to next item →